

t can be combination of all other solutions together

- DevSecOps
- Software Compliance
- Automated Software Delivery

Also it can contain the evaluation of the performance and technical metrics. This can be identified due to

- enterprise fast growing outpaced the silo tools and inefficient toolchain - top value is to deliver better product faster with efficiency gains
- enterprise is rolling out standard toolchains due to merger and acquisitions
- existing tools are not cloud ready and cloud transformation is accelerating for the enterprise to be more competitive and delivery SaaS services while saving the cost

Input to the POV

The pre-requisition of this scope of POV tend to be focused with these aspects:

- Value driven capabilities leading in with Automated Software Delivery
- technical integrating with existing either Open Source Toolchain or other commercial tools
- Technical metrics for performance and scalability for large enterprises

Suggested Success Criteria

- Business Driver: end to end DevOps but with integration to support across the board initiative, particularly digital transformation or accelerated cloud initiative.
- Enterprise Initiative and Sponsor: CTO and enterprise wide developer's experience and operations efficiency
- Required capabilities with the objectives to have a platform to address immediately needs and future proof for flexibility and high end scalability

| Required Capability | Acceptance | Objective | GitLab Feature |

| --- | | --- | | --- | | --- | |

| Continous Integration | Similar to automated software delivery but may have specific performance metrics for given user and repository size | Automation and Standard CI Practice | Continous Integration, Git Flow and Repository |

| Integration of Platform to Other Tools | Ability to Integrate with Various Tools in the Ecosystem | Integration and End to end process flow supported | Integration points, webhooks, APIs for the given integration scope |

| Cloud Native Continous Deployment | Containization and K8S Support | Accelerate Cloud Initiative and Cloud Native Toolchain | Cloud Native CI/CD and GitLab Server/Runner being Cloud Native |

| Developers Experience | Streamlined Experience for High Velocity | New and Better Developer Tools to Attract and Retain Talents | Single User Interface, High Usability, Customizable UI |

In addition it can be combined with DevSecOps and Software Compliance for Ultimate.

The POV can be multi-phased and more than 60 days. It is critical to have written and agreed upon scope and acceptance, and buy commitment especially for the later phase of POV when

revenue generating apps are loaded in for test.

See this example for references for a large new logo 2-phase POV.

If you have identified the platform POV, reach out to the Strategic Field team for qualification, scoping and acceptance definition, particularly mapping the technical metrics to business values.

Proof Points Consideration

If the platform based POV is focusing on the technical matrix, it may require setup of HA-based GitLab with scalable runner fleets which can result in a wide range of technical issues. The account team needs to possess this technical capabilities with priority support. This scope of work needs to be managed with a detailed project management steps and issue tracking. The technical metrics acceptance must be clarified and mutually agreed with feasibility to carry out in 4-6 weeks.

It is recommended to provide proof points from other sources, instead of carrying out large scale POV. For example the proof points can be obtained using gitlab.com itself and reference customers with similar user and repo counts, and similar technology / cloud profile.

Other POV Scope and Acceptance

SA working with SAE and AE can define the POV scope with the customer, with alignment to the business values and the GitLab solution. For each solution, the typical scope and acceptances are listed for reference but the team should define the scope, time and execution with acceptance for each engagement.

- DevSecOps
- Software Compliance
- Automated Software Delivery

SECTION: solutions-architects/tools-and-resources/stackoverflow/_index.md

Stack Overflow

Stack Overflow for Teams is a knowledge sharing and collaboration tool, available to the Solution Architecture (SA), Customer Success (CS), Professional Services (PS) and SMB sales teams.

The purpose is to:

1. To provide a knowledge sharing forum where SAs, CSMs, CSAs, SMB reps, PSEs and others can continue to evolve as learning organizations, where team members can have their questions answered on elements of the GitLab Platform in a timely fashion, and be retained beyond the limits currently in Slack today.
2. To provide an avenue to continue the onboarding and accelerate the growth of SA and CS teams, so that team members can gain GitLab platform expertise themselves more efficiently, and

have fun and be rewarded for doing so.

Note the GitLab support organization utilizes ZenDesk for its knowledge base services.

Everyone in the Solution Architecture (SA), Customer Success (CS), Professional Services (PS) and SMB sales teams organizations, has access to the Stack Overflow for Teams via Okta and is able to answer questions or provide responses directly through the web interface.

Additionally, it is possible to interact with Stack Overflow using Slack integration using following commands:

- /stack ask How do I do X? to ask a question directly via Slack
- /stack search [search term] to search for questions and answers

Slack integration also posts notifications about new questions and answers via cs-questions Slack channel for the entire team to stay up to date and boost participation. Adherent to and in support of GitLab's efficiency value team members should first search for an existing answer and post a question only if an answer is not readily available.

How Stack Overflow KB differs from the Docs & Highspot

The knowledge base and our product documentation are both key elements of GitLab's digital support experience that serve different needs:

```
{{< cardpane >}}
{{% card header="Stack Overflow" %}}
```

- Questions and Answers on Product Features, Architecture
- Articles as Knowledge Dumps, or Drafts before becoming blogs, Docs
- Best Practices around Adoption at Scale: Onboarding, Management, Automation, Value Metrics
- Used "just in time".

```
{{% /card %}}
```

```
{{% card header="HighSpot/ SME Hub" %}}
```

- Fairly Static content; GTM/ Customer Presentations
- Discovery Questions, FAQs, Technical Evaluation Assets
- List of Enablement Recordings, Standard Demos, Whiteboarding examples
- Sales Plays; SA Enablement
- Used "recent in time".

```
{{% /card %}}
```

```
{{% card header="Docs or Zendesk KB" %}}
```

- Learn about product features and how to use them.
- Provides an overview of the current version of our products.
- Best Practices around Deployment at Scale: Configuration, Migration, Administration,

Monitoring, Break Fix
- Used "ahead of time".

```
{{% /card %}}  
{{< /cardpane >}}
```

You can use this as a guide when deciding what should be in Highspot/ SME Hub, Stack Overflow for Teams, or GitLab Docs, Blogs or Zendesk KB.

StackOverflow Workflows

1. Onboarding and Off-boarding: The process and workflow to onboard and offboard SAs, CS, PSEs, SMBs and Dev Advocates onto and off Stack Overflow is described here.

1. Administration: Community management, becoming a moderator, tag maintenance, and integrations with Slack, Okta and others are described here.

1. Adopting StackOverflow KB: The process to ask a question, provide an answer, write Knowledge Articles/ How to Guides, improving GitLab docs from Stack Overflow content is described here.

1. Measuring StackOverflow Impact: How to become and Grow as a SME, and how to measure outcomes achieved is described here.

SECTION: solutions-architects/tools-and-resources/stackoverflow/administration.md

Community management, becoming a moderator, tag maintenance, and integrations with Slack, Okta and others are described here.

Roles

Admins

StackOverflow Admins have the following responsibilities:

- Manage user accounts and access
- Configure team settings and permissions
- Handle technical implementation aspects
- Manage integrations with other systems
- Oversee security settings

The current Admins are:

- {{< member-by-name "David Astor" >}} representing the SA Org
- {{< member-by-name "Jonathan Fullam" >}} representing the SA Org
- {{< member-by-name "Tiffany McAtee" >}} representing the CS Org
- {{< member-by-name "Brian Will" >}} representing the PS Org
- {{< member-by-name "Mike Lindsay" >}} representing the PS Org
- {{< member-by-name "Kathleen Rintelman-Betances" >}} representing Sales Operations
- {{< member-by-name "Mitchell Hanks" >}} representing the SMB Sales Org
- {{< member-by-name "Ancil McBarnett" >}} representing the SA Org

Community Managers

Community Managers are typically employees of Stack Overflow who:

- Oversee the overall health of multiple communities
- Handle escalated issues that moderators cannot resolve
- Create and implement community policies
- Provide guidance and support to moderators
- Manage community-wide initiatives and features
- Have access to more powerful administrative tools

The current Community Managers are:

- {{< member-by-name "David Astor" >}} representing the SA Org
- {{< member-by-name "Tiffany McAtee" >}} representing the CS Org
- {{< member-by-name "Sean Hoyle" >}} representing the CS Org
- {{< member-by-name "Brian Will" >}} representing the PS Org
- {{< member-by-name "Mike Lindsay" >}} representing the PS Org
- {{< member-by-name "Mitchell Hanks" >}} representing the SMB Sales Org
- {{< member-by-name "Ancil McBarnett" >}} representing the SA Org

Moderators

Moderators are usually trusted members of the community who:

- Manage Tags (especially for SME Areas)
- Handle day-to-day moderation tasks
- Review flagged content
- Address user behavior issues
- Enforce community guidelines
- Can lock, delete, or edit problematic posts
- Act as liaisons between the community and Community Managers

The current Moderators are:

- {{< member-by-name "Ken McKnight" >}} and {{< member-by-name "Bradley Lee" >}} representing the CICD SME Area
- {{< member-by-name "Ken McKnight" >}} and {{< member-by-name "Darwin Sanoy" >}} representing the Embedded DevOps SME Area
- {{< member-by-name "Jess Perry" >}}, {{< member-by-name "Yu-Chen Hsueh" >}}, {{< member-by-name "Eduardo Gillen" >}}, {{< member-by-name "Julia Gatjens" >}}, {{< member-by-name "Bryan Miller" >}} representing the AppSec SME Area
- {{< member-by-name "Jess Perry" >}}, {{< member-by-name "Omar Bickell" >}}, {{< member-by-name "Sarah Bailey" >}}, {{< member-by-name "John Bush" >}}, {{< member-by-name "Rasheed Babatunde" >}} representing the AppSec SME Area representing the PS Org
- TBD representing the Agile Plan SME Area
- {{< member-by-name "Falko Sieverding" >}} representing the Dedicated SME Area
- {{< member-by-name "Erica Wilson" >}} representing the SMB Sales Org
- TBD representing the PS Org

SECTION: solutions-architects/tools-and-resources/stackoverflow/adoping.md

The process to ask a question, provide an answer, write Knowledge Articles/ How to Guides, improving GitLab docs from Stack Overflow content is described here.

Asking a Question

Please refer to Stack Overflow training on

- Slack and Stack Overflow
- Questions and Answers
- Overflow AI- Auto Answer in Slack
- General User Enablement (Stack)

mermaid

flowchart TD

```
A[SA or CSM has question] --> B[They go to SME Slack channel]
B --> C{Used /stack search?}
C -->|Yes| D[Stack Overflow searches for answers]
C -->|No| E{Used /stack ask?}
D --> F{Answers found?}
F -->|Yes| G[User selects best answer]
G --> H[Answer displayed in Slack]
H --> Z[Knowledge utilized]
F -->|No or not satisfactory| E
E -->|Yes| J[User enters data: Title, Body, Tags]
E -->|No| I[Another SA nudges to use /stack ask]
I --> E
J --> K[Stack confirms question posted]
K --> L[Stack Overflow AI searches KB repository]
L --> M{Answers found?}
M -->|Yes| N[AI returns answers for upvoting/acceptance]
N --> O[User reviews and accepts answers]
M -->|No| P[Stack provides link to question]
P --> Q[Question presented back in original Slack channel]
Q --> R[Other SAs view and provide answers]
O --> S[Knowledge captured in Stack Overflow registry]
R --> S
```

Providing an Answer

Upvoting an Answer

Writing Knowledge Articles/ How to Guides/ Best Practices {best-practices-guide}

Please refer to Stack Overflow training on

- Articles

Think of a collection as a folder than span multiple Tags.

TBD: We would like to use Collections for onboarding SMEs into the various SME Areas.

Suggested Collections (based on appropriate tags) would be around

- Each SME Area: AI, Dedicated, App Sec, Agile Planning, CI/CD, Metrics & Observation
- Each Vertical: Financials, Embedded DevOps, Telecommunications

Communities of Practices

Please refer to Stack Overflow training on

- Communities)

Suggested Communities of Practices (based on appropriate tags) should be aligned with Product focuses such as:

- Modernization & Analytics
- AI
- Core DevOps Workflows
- Security & Compliance
- Platforms
- Competitive
- Internal Development Platforms
- Platform Engineering

SECTION: solutions-architects/tools-and-resources/stackoverflow/onboarding.md

The process and workflow to onboard and offboard SAs, CS, PSEs, SMBs and Dev Advocates onto and off Stack Overflow is described here.

SECTION: solutions-architects/tools-and-resources/stackoverflow/outcomes.md

How to become and Grow as a SME, and how to measure outcomes achieved is described here

SECTION: support/_index.md

Welcome to the GitLab Support Team Handbook

The GitLab Support Team provides technical support to GitLab.com and Self-Managed GitLab customers. The GitLab Support Team Handbook is the central repository for why and how we work the way we do.

| If you are | Your Need | Where You Should Look |

| ----- | ----- | ----- |

| A customer, or an advocate for a customer | Technical assistance | Public Support Page, which describes the best way to get the help you need and lists GitLab's paid service offerings |

| GitLab team member | Technical assistance | Internal Support for GitLab Team Members page |

| New Support Team member | Onboarding / Learning | Support Engineer Responsibilities page and Support Learning Pathways |

| New Support Manager | Onboarding / Learning | Support Manager Responsibilities page and Support Manager Pathways |

Know someone who might be a great fit for our team? Please refer them to the job-family descriptions below.

- Support Engineering Job Family
- Support Management Job Family

What does the Support Team do?

We care for our customers

- Always assume you are the person responsible for ensuring success for the customer.
- When supporting a customer, any issue, incident or loss is GitLab's loss.
 - When a customer experiences trouble or downtime, take action with the same urgency you'd have if GitLab were experiencing downtime.
 - When a customer is losing productivity, take action with the same urgency you'd have if GitLab were losing productivity.
 - A customer with 2,500 users whose instance is down, gets the same urgency as if GitLab were losing \$1,000,000 per day.
- Escalate early. Visibility across GitLab, up to and including the CEO, is always better earlier rather than later. Ensure all resources needed are on the case for customers early.

Remember, as members of the support team we are the first to interact with someone when they have a problem or question. As such it is up to us to represent the company and make sure we present ourselves properly. Therefore we are expected to:

- Always be friendly and respectful.
- Be open to new ideas and points of view.
- Be OK if you don't know something. You can always ask someone else.
- Be comfortable saying no to a customer (but try to suggest a workaround and escalate to a Senior if necessary).

We are not commissioned or bonused

Our goal is to provide guidance that will lead to the best results for our customers as they use GitLab. In that, we will often point to documentation, product functionality, or open bugs/feature requests.

However, there are times when customers will be best served through one of our commercial offerings.

Support is part of the Engineering Department and Support Engineers are not commissioned or bonused for upsell for additional services, customer purchases, or lead generation.

If you recommend Professional Services or moving to a different tier or offering you may link to this section in your recommendation to give the customer assurance you're doing so with no mixed motivations.

Our role within GitLab

GitLab Support is part of the Engineering division.

While most engineering departments are part of the R&D cost center,

Support is part of the Cost of Sales (or sometimes Cost of Goods Sold (COGS)) cost center.

This unique arrangement is expressed in our Key Performance Indicators, which are largely focused around pursuing customer success and satisfaction while driving efficiency by increasing output while keeping costs within a predefined range.

This is also why Support Engineer responsibilities include contributing code and documentation and working alongside Product Managers on our products: By using the knowledge gained from interacting with our customers to make our products or docs better, we solve problems before they become one. This reduces support case load while increasing efficiency for the wider GitLab organization. For example, the Sales department can rely on our docs to answer customer queries instead of leaning on Support or Customer Success for help, freeing up more time to close sales.

Building customer empathy

Part of Support's role is to amplify the voice of the customer. One way of doing this is inviting other GitLab team members into experiences that will help them understand customer challenges with the product or our own obstacles in helping customers overcome those challenges.

Before you start, make sure you get light-agent access in Zendesk so that you can view Support tickets.

If you're looking to get more exposure to customers, there are a few ways to get involved with Support:

Support Shadow Program

GitLab team members interested in learning about the GitLab Support team and our responsibilities are encouraged to participate in the Support Shadow Program. The Support Shadow Program is a way that team members outside of Support can spend time shadowing,

learning, collaborating, and working together with the GitLab Support team.

If you're not part of the Support team and you'd like to participate in this program, open a Support Shadow Program issue in the support-team-meta project. This issue will be used to organize, plan, and track progress toward this program.

GitLab Support uses Calendly to facilitate scheduling Shadow pairing sessions with participants. If you're part of the Support team and you'd like to volunteer to host Support Shadow Pairing sessions with folks outside of Support, please open a Schedule update request issue requesting that Support Ops add you to the Support Shadow Program Calendly rotation.

Join Support Calls

Support calls are published on the GitLab Support Calendar. There are:

- Customer calls between customers and engineers. The description will include a ticket ID. Go to <https://gitlab.zendesk.com/agent/tickets/<id>> to view the ticket.
- Pairing sessions between two or more engineers working on one or more tickets.
- Office hours / Help sessions where more experienced Support engineers share their knowledge.
- Training sessions where a member of the support team is presenting on a specific topic

Join an Emergency Call

A great way to get involved is to join a customer emergency call. You can monitor supportself-managed for PagerDuty alerts. Alternatively, if you have access to PagerDuty you can be scheduled into a shadow rotation.

How our team helps fellow team members at all levels -- Helping Hierarchy

If you go through the responsibilities for each role in Support you can piece together how the organization works. We wanted to make a simple clear way to think about how the roles work together to solve problems:

- Support Engineers help solve customer problems via tickets, merge requests, and other customer facing activities.
- Managers help solve Support Engineer problems by removing obstacles, joining in on customer facing activities, and working with support engineers to build systems that work to reduce friction and enable results and efficiency.
- Senior Leaders help resolve and avoid scaling problems by addressing team performance to KPIs, prioritizing initiatives and being responsible for the achievement of global results.
- VP of Support helps resolve and avoid company wide problems, by identifying growth and team design challenges, and reporting on progress to the Executives and Board.

This simple list helps to give an easy way to set expectations and align problem solving in different roles.

How we measure our performance

We use Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) to keep track of how well each Engineering Department is doing, including the Support team, as a whole.

The KPI measurements can be found under the Reporting tab in Zendesk if you have the appropriate access, but progress on meeting these KPIs is also tracked via the aforementioned KPI link.

We review these KPIs weekly in the Support Week-in-Review.

Our Success Pillars

In service of achieving our KPIs and OKRs, there are three key pillars that we must balance to achieve success:

- People: Continue to hire excellent engineers and managers, at the right time, and the right places. Support our existing engineers and work with each team member towards realizing their full potential through professional development and smart tooling.
- Process: Iterate on existing processes and develop new, simplified processes that enable global scaling.
- Performance: People understand how their contributions help the global team attain our results, with guidance on what these contributions look like in practice.

At various times it's easy to over-optimize on one of the pillars to solve a problem, but considering all three is key to avoiding short-sighted decision making.

About the Support Team

The Single Source of Truth

for information about Support Team Members - everything from email address and personal interests to product skills and group memberships - is the support-team project.

The Support Team Home Page is

built from the information in that project. Many other Support tools and automations make use of it also. See the

Support team entry page

of the Support Team wiki

for details of the structure of an individual Support team member's file.

Information for and about the different parts of the Support Team can be found in the following sections of the Support Handbook:

- /support/engineering is content that is for Support Engineers. Think: Zendesk workflows and technical resources.
- /support/license-and-renewals is content for the Licensing and Renewals Support Engineers and Managers. Think: customers.gitlab.com and working with the Fulfillment Product Team.
- /support/managers is content that is for Support Managers. Think: how to manage issues, run 1:1s and leadership sync information.
- /support/readiness is the landing page for Support Readiness. Think: how is the support team preparing for X?

Below we also have some commonly referenced pages:

- Support Engineer responsibilities

- Support Engineer knowledge areas
- Support Engineer career path
- Support Manager responsibilities

{{% include "includes/we-are-also-product-development.md" %}}

Dogfooding in Support

Citing our dogfooding operating principle, people sometimes ask why GitLab Support doesn't use Service Desk.

Dogfooding is using a piece of GitLab for its intended purpose. For example, one could use GitLab issues as a newsletter (and we do! See: Support Week in Review), but creating merge requests to help Issues serve as a newsletter more effectively wouldn't be dogfooding unless that improvement also helps its core use case.

In other words: Dogfooding is using the product in the way that our customers would use it to the end of discovering and solving pain points that they have. Dogfooding supports customer results.

At GitLab Support we use Service Desk to process Personal Data Requests, but not for our global support because the customer for Service Desk is primarily small teams soliciting bug reports, feature requests, or general feedback. Through our use of Service Desk in this smaller setting we've been able to influence product direction towards adding features like internal notes.

We continually evaluate product features for use-cases within Support and provide feedback and feature requests where blockers exist. Support will always prioritize customer results over any other consideration.

OKRs

Current Quarter

These were previously populated via a tool we are no longer using.
TODO: Replace with current GitLab implementation

Previous Quarter

These were previously populated via a tool we are no longer using.
TODO: Replace with current GitLab implementation

Hazards and Challenges

See Managers/Hazards page

Communications

The GitLab Support Team is part of the wider Engineering function. Be sure to check the communications section in the Engineering handbook

for tips on how to keep yourself informed about engineering announcements and initiatives.

Here are our most important modes of communication:

- Support Week in Review. Important updates for everyone in support.

The SWIR is expected reading/listening for all support team members. You should try to check the SWIR at least once a week. If you have something to share with the entire team this is the best place to do it. For example, if you have an issue for a common bug, an issue that requires feedback, or an issue about an external project you're working on.

- Slack channels for "informal" communication.

Due to our data retention policy in Slack, things shared there will eventually be deleted. If you want to share something there, please make sure it also has a more permanent place in our docs, handbook, issue tracker, etc.

- Meta issue tracker for any issues regarding workflows, general team suggestions, tasks or projects related to support, etc.

Where we want to ensure that important messages are passed to the global support team, we will use this messaging template. This ensures that these messages are delivered across our communications channels in a structured and documented manner.

GitLab.com

Groups

We use the following GitLab Groups to notify or add support team members to issues and merge requests on GitLab.com.

Group	Who
@gitlab-com/support	All Support Team members
@gitlab-com/support/amer	AMER Support
@gitlab-com/support/apac	APAC Support
@gitlab-com/support/emea	EMEA Support
@gitlab-com/support/dotcom	Support members with primary SaaS focus and GitLab.com admin access
@gitlab-com/support/dotcom/console	Support members with GitLab.com console access
@gitlab-com/support/customers-console	Support members with CustomersDot console access
@gitlab-com/support/licensing-subscription	Support members focused on License and Renewals
@gitlab-com/support/managers	All support managers
@gitlab-com/support/managers/amer	All AMER support managers
@gitlab-com/support/managers/apac	All APAC support managers
@gitlab-com/support/managers/emea	All EMEA support managers

Projects

Our team projects and issue trackers can be found in the Support parent group. Here are some selected projects which are relevant to team communications.

Project	Purpose
support-team-meta	Issues to discuss and improve Support processes
support-training	Courses and training for Support team including onboarding
support-pairing	Record of pairing sessions where we work together on tickets
feedback	Collects SSAT survey responses from Zendesk in the form of issues
support-operations	Support Operations team project
support-readiness	Support Readiness project

Support team meta issue tracker

We use the Support meta issue tracker for tracking issues and creating issues that may require feedback around support.

If you're interested in working on a project or task related to support feel free to create an issue and link to any external issues or projects so that we can:

- Be transparent to the entire team what we're working on
- Have the opportunity to collaborate on external projects or tasks with other team members who are interested
- Avoid having team members do duplicate work

Issues regarding documentation or features for GitLab, our FOSS project or any of the GitLab components should not go in this issue tracker, but in their appropriate issue tracker.

If you have a proposed solution that is actionable, it's best to start a merge request, tag the team for feedback and link in the Support Week in Review.

Slack

We follow GitLab's general guidelines for using Slack for team communications. As only 90 days of activity will be retained, make sure to move important information into the team handbook, product documentation, issue trackers or customer tickets.

sptvs. support prefix

When naming channels, "spt" is meant for internal channels, meaning those that will be of use to the Support Team mainly. They should be public so others may join if they choose. If a channel has a "support" prefix, it is meant as a public interface where other teams will interact with the Support Team.

Daily Stand-up bot

The Support Daily Slackbot is an automated tool designed to facilitate daily standup Slack threads across various teams and regions at GitLab. It posts customized messages to specific Slack channels based on type and target. For further details of the different variations, please refer to the README file.

Channels

Channel	Purpose
-----	-----
supportteam-chat	Support team lounge for banter, chat and status updates
supportgitlab-com	Discuss GitLab.com tickets and customer issues
supportself-managed	Discuss self-managed tickets and customer issues
supportgitlab-dedicated	Discuss GitLab Dedicated tickets and customer issues
supportlicensing-subscription	Discuss Licensing & Renewals tickets and customer issues
supportticket-attention-requests	Discuss escalated tickets with the Support Manager On-Call
supportoperations	Discuss operational items related to how Support works
supportleadership	Discuss support team internal matters which require support managers' attention
recruiting-support-engineering	Discuss support team hiring-related matters
sptamerglobal	Discuss topics specific to Global SEs in AMER
sptemea	Discuss topics specific to Global SEs in EMEA
sptapac	Discuss topics specific to Global SEs in APAC
sptpairing	Used when working together on tickets and issues
sptus-government	Discussion about topics pertaining to US Fed Support
sptonboarding	New here? Topics related to onboarding

Private Channels

At GitLab we are to be public by default unless there is a valid reason for it to not be public. While Slack is not public, the spirit of opening up discussions so that everyone can contribute means that private channels should be kept to a minimum.

The following private channels are permanent fixtures in support. Usage estimates are approximate based on traffic in Feb 2022.

Channel	Who is in it	Purpose	How often is it used?
----	----	----	----
spt-vp-directors	Directors+	Used for Senior leadership to discuss and coordinate on sensitive topics / budget / etc.	3-4 threads per week
sptmanagers-internal	Managers+	Used for sensitive topics that are applicable to managers that aren't appropriate for public channels	4-5 threads per week
sptmanagers-internal-apac	APAC Managers+	Used for sensitive topics that are applicable to APAC managers that aren't appropriate for public channels	3-4 threads per week
sptmanagers-emea	EMEA Managers+	Used for sensitive topics that are applicable to EMEA managers that aren't appropriate for public channels	4-5 threads per week
sptmanagers-amer	AMER Managers+	Used for sensitive topics that are applicable to AMER managers that aren't appropriate for public channels	1-2 threads per week
sphiring-mgmt	Managers+, Recruiting, Finance	Used for coordinating offers and discussing hiring specifics that can be shared in the public channel	1-2 threads per week
fy23supportpromotions	Managers+, People Business Partner	Used for coordinating and planning promotions in FY23	0 threads per week, mostly informational
sptleadershipinternal	Managers+, Staff+	Private version of supportleadership, used for sensitive topics where Staff and Managers are the appropriate audience	rarely used

| sptstaffinternal | Staff+ | Used for sensitive topics that are applicable to Staff Engineers that aren't appropriate for public channels | rarely used |

Before starting a new private channel, ask yourself Why can't everyone contribute here? Appropriate answers might be:

- this channel will be used to discuss material, non-public information that may affect designated insider status.
- this channel will be used to discuss something that would negatively affect the privacy of an individual or group of individuals, such as performance, compensation or other sensitive matters

Private channels are not appropriate for:

- Reducing noise (create a new public channel for this)
- Long-lasting discussions (unless included in the table above)
- Getting materials ready for public comment

Values are only values if you do them when it is hard. See more discussion on how to scale the business while preserving GitLab Values.

User Groups

Group	Who
-----	---
@support-dotcom	Support Team Members with GitLab.com Admin Access
@support-selfmanaged	Support Team focused on Self-Managed tickets
@support-team-apac	Support Team APAC
@support-team-emea	Support Team EMEA
@support-team-america	Support Team AMER
@supportmanagers	Support Managers
@support-managers-apac	Support Managers APAC
@support-managers-emea	Support Managers EMEA

If you need to be added to one or more of these groups, please open an issue in the access requests project.

Google Calendar

We use the following team calendars to coordinate events and meetings:

- GitLab Support Calendar ID gitlab.com9bs159ehrc5tqglur88djbd51k@group.calendar.google.com
- Support - Time off Calendar ID gitlab.comas6a088eo3mrvbo57n5kddmgdg@group.calendar.google.com
- Support - Customer Events - EXPERIMENTAL: see support-team-meta5153

Add these calendars to your GitLab Google calendar by clicking on the "+" sign next to "other calendars", and choose "subscribe to calendar". Enter the relevant ID mentioned above. If you need access to these calendars, ask a support team member for help.

Zoom

Zoom name format

Please use the following formats for your name in Zoom as described in adding your title to your name in Zoom. As a primarily customer facing team, these formats were chosen to help identify you by vendor and role in calls where customers are present.

For the sub-department, use the smallest unit you belong to. Again, bias for customer understanding over technical correctness.

For example,

- Customer Support -> Support Engineering (use Support Engineering)
- Customer Support -> Support Readiness -> Support Operations (use Support Operations)
- Customer Support -> Support Engineering -> US Federal Support (use US Federal Support)

Examples

- Intermediate Support Engineer: Name | Support Engineer | GitLab - Luciana de Santos | Support Engineer | GitLab
- Support Readiness Specialist - Ops: Name | Support Ops Specialist | GitLab - Barka Adamec | Support Ops Specialist | GitLab
- Senior Support Engineer: Name | Sr. Support Engineer | GitLab - Shen Hua Li | Sr. Support Engineer | GitLab
- Staff Support Engineer: Name | Staff Support Engineer | GitLab - Jabulani Achebe | Staff Support Engineer | GitLab
- Support Manager: Name | Manager, Sub-department | GitLab - Sneha Sharma | Manager, Support Operations | GitLab
- Senior Support Manager: Name | Sr. Manager, Sub-department | GitLab | Joo Hee Ko | Sr. Manager, US Federal Support | GitLab
- Director: Name | Director, Sub-department | GitLab | Noémie Blanchet | Director, Support Engineering | GitLab
- Vice President: Name | VP, Department | GitLab - Kalina Nowak | VP, Customer Support | GitLab

Weekly Meetings

The Support Team has several meetings each week. These allow us to coordinate and help us all grow together. Each meeting has its own agenda and is led by a different member of the team each week.

Discussions are encouraged to be kept in issues or merge requests so the entire team can collaborate, regardless of time zone.

Any demos or announcements that need to be shared with the entire team should be shared in the Support Week in Review.

All Zoom and agenda links can be found on the relevant calendar entry in the Support Calendar..

Support Team Call

Support team members in some regions meet up regularly.
Details of these calls are on the [Weekly Support Team Call workflow page](#).

Support Leadership Meetings

The Support management team meets regularly. Details of these calls are on the [Support Managers page](#)

Support Monthly Business Review (MBR)

The leadership team (Staff, Managers, Senior Managers, Directors) meet monthly to align on business objectives and cross-region collaboration. There is SAFE data shared, but a read-out is disseminated for wider team awareness.

Support Regional Team Meetings

Some regional Support teams have meetings oriented around company news, Support initiatives, training plans, and connectedness.

Weekday	Region	Meeting Name	Purpose
:-----:	:---:	:-----:	:-----:
Tuesday	APAC	Team Meeting	
Tuesday	AMER	Team Meeting	
Thursday	EMEA	Team Meeting	

Senior Support Engineer Office Hours

Senior and Staff Support Engineers are encouraged to host office hours. These office hours are intended to strengthen the team through mentoring. It is up to each Senior/Staff Support Engineer whether they schedule office hours, and how often. Please see the "GitLab Support" Team calendar to view office hours and invite yourself.

We encourage hosts to include what they will cover in the calendar event description and optionally a document to track.

Some ideas of what one can expect at a Senior/Staff Support Engineers' office hour:

- Troubleshooting a difficult ticket
- Trying out a GitLab feature (Geo, CI, SAST, k8s, etc.) or a new workflow
- Reproducing a particular bug
- Fixing a bug
- Creating or updating documentation
- Thinking through a particular problem
- Hosting a ticket crush session

Creating a Meeting

You may wish to host a sync call. To do so, you can create an event on the [Support Calendar](#).. To invite team members to the event, you can use the appropriate Support email alias ([internal](#)

Handbook, GitLab team members only)

Support Week in Review

Every Friday, we do a week in review, inspired by the greater Engineering organization week in review. You can add topics any time by using the SWIR topic form.

Any workflow changes or announcements should be shared in the SWIR and we recommend you check at least once a week to stay up to date on recent changes. Ideally, the information shared here should have a permanent location such as an issue or merge request.

How to read/listen to the SWIR

- You can read the Support Week in Review by viewing the more recent issue with the SWIR::Digest label in the SWIR project.
- You can subscribe to this label to be notified when the latest SWIR has been generated.
- For audio editions recorded after 2022/07/01, you can find a link to the audio edition of the SWIR within the respective issue (this is so we comply with the SAFE framework. An archive of all audio editions can be found in the Support Week in Review - Audio Edition folder on Google Drive (internal only).

We encourage anyone in the team to share.

SWIR Topics

We currently have the following topics, each in its own section in the SWIR:

- Actionable. For items that require a decision to be made or action to be taken (such as, asking for feedback on an issue).
- Things to know about. Share items that you would like to share with the team, like projects you're working on, known bugs, new workflows, cool articles you found, etc.
- Team Member updates. New team members, internal transfers and other news about our team members!
- What Did we Learn this Week. A space to share things you've discovered (or rediscovered!) and learnt.
- Support Operations Corner. Announcements and information from the Support Operations team
- Kudos. Give a special kudos to other team members or highlight something they did.
 - SSAT. A selection of the positive SSAT feedback received from customers during the week
- Metrics report. Review the support metrics for the span of the week.

SWIR Labels

SWIR Issues can also have their own Tags or Labels in the GitLab project. These are used to highlight specific Areas of Focus (L&R, SaaS...). Labels are used on the Issues only, they do not appear in the digest Issue nor in the Google doc.

One label, Manager Attention, is used for policy changes or other topics of which Support Managers should specifically be made aware. You can find the Manager Attention label [here](#)]

and subscribe to it.

You can read about the origins of the auto-generated SWIR in this issue.

Cross-Department Roles

The Support Team collaborates with many other departments throughout GitLab - Sales, Channel, Product and Legal, to name a few. And we have created two different roles to help those collaborations to be as effective and efficient as possible.

Support Stable Counterpart

The Support Stable Counterpart role is designed to provide a strong connection between a product or non-product team and Support. The purpose is discussing product issues, sharing product knowledge and representing customer needs, as well as sharing knowledge about each team's work and developing processes and documentation to allow the two teams to work together well. If you are interested in becoming a Support Stable Counterpart, or would like to learn more about the role, read the [Support Stable Counterparts](#) page.

Processes

Updating Support Team documents using merge requests

The Support Team records our institutional knowledge, processes and workflows in multiple places, such as the handbook and project issues templates. When updating such documents, make sure to have visible artifacts of approval on your merge requests before merging even if you have received approval somewhere else. This avoids the impression of changes being made without any oversight or accountability.

Artifacts of approval can include:

- Getting a peer or manager to review and merge your MR
- A peer or manager showing their approval using MR approvals
- A peer or manager commenting "looks good to me"

Support Workflows

- Support Workflows
 - Internal Policies and Procedures Wiki
 - How to Work with Tickets
 - How to Submit issues to Product/Development
 - How to Submit Code to the GitLab Application
 - How to Submit Docs when working on customer issues
- License & Renewals Workflows

Slack Workflows

Each Slack channel within Support has a number of Workflows attached to them that are used to provide information to users. The source files for each workflow live in the slack-workflows project.

Issue Notification

Some workflows are meant to notify the team of new issues created in the relevant project. In these cases, a project webhook passes information to Zapier, which then sends the information to a Slack workflow.

- supportgitlab-com
 - CMOC GitLab Project, Zap, Slack workflow
- supportlicensing-subscription
 - L&R related internal requests GitLab Project, Zap, Slack workflow

Emoji Reaction

Providing information by reacting to a message with a specific emoji.

- supportescalations
 - Ticket Escalation - :escalate: - Directs the user to follow the proper procedure to escalate a support ticket or internal issue.
- supportgitlab-com
 - Ticket Escalation - :escalate: - Directs the user to follow the proper procedure to escalate a support ticket or internal issue.
 - Question Redirect - :leftwardsarrowwithhook: - Directs the user to post their question in a more appropriate Slack channel.
 - Remove Link Preview - :slack: - Politely asks the user to remove any unfurled link previews in their message.
 - Welcome - This automated workflow automatically sends a direct message to new members of the channel that contains helpful information.
 - Contact Management - :admissiontickets: - Direct the user to follow the proper procedure to manage the support contacts for a Zendesk Global organization.
- supportself-managed
 - Ticket Escalation - :escalate: - Directs the user to follow the proper procedure to escalate a support ticket or internal issue.
- supportlicensing-subscription
 - Ticket Escalation - :escalate: - Directs the user to follow the proper procedure to escalate a support ticket or internal issue.

Time Off

See the Support Time Off page

Onboarding

See the Support Onboarding page

Promotion

After getting promoted, make sure to update your title in:

- our Support team page, and the change would be reflected in Zendesk
- the company team page following the same steps in Add yourself to the Team Page

Consider updating the title on Slack and on Zoom, following the guidelines in Zoom name format.

Support Pods

In GitLab Support, we use Support Pods to organize support engineers as they work. Each Support Pod is a cross-region, single skill group of engineers who are interested in their Support Pod's specific product area. They are engineer-lead. To join or start a Support Pod you can read more below.

See the Support Pods handbook page and the Working with Support Pods workflow page.

Improving our processes - 'Active Now' issue board

The Support team uses 'support-team-meta' project issues to track ideas and initiatives to improve our processes. The 'Active Now' issue board shows what we're currently working on. It uses three labels:

1. Blocked - waiting for another team or external resource before we can move ahead
1. Discussing this week - under active discussion to arrive at a decision
1. In Progress - actively being worked on

Some principles guide how these labels are used:

1. A maximum of six issues at any time for each label (18 total issues)
1. All issues with one of the above labels must be assigned to one or more support team members
1. All issues with one of the above labels must have a due date no longer than a week ahead
1. If an issue is too big to complete in a week it should be split into smaller parts that can be completed in a week (a larger 'parent' issue is OK to keep in the project, but it shouldn't make it onto the 'In Progress' column)

Each week we look at the board and discuss the issues to keep things moving forward.

By keeping a maximum of six issues for each label, we limit work in progress and make sure things are completed before starting new tasks.

Adding and managing items on the board:

Support managers will regularly review the board to keep items moving forward.

1. The team can vote on issues not on the board by giving a 'thumbs up' emoji so we can see popular issues.
1. Support managers will look at popular issues and add them to the board when there is room.
1. Support managers will curate issues to prevent a large backlog. Unpopular or old issues can

be closed / merged to keep the backlog manageable.

Support Slackbot

The Support Slackbot (archived) has been retired.

Support Resources

Handbook links

- GitLab Team page
- Product Categories - Find out what team handles what
- Statement Of Support
- Support Managers
- Support Hiring
- Support Channels
- On-Call
- License & Renewals
- Advanced Topics
- Browser extensions
- AI and Support Work

Documentation

- GitLab
 - GitLab.com Status
 - GitLab Releases
- Writing docs
 - GitLab Documentation guidelines
 - Documentation Style Guide
 - GitLab Markdown
- Setting up GitLab
 - GitLab Architecture Overview
 - Requirements
 - Installation methods for GitLab
 - Backing up and restoring GitLab
 - Omnibus configuration settings
 - Omnibus Configuration options
 - Omnibus Database settings
- Debugging GitLab
 - Log system
 - Rake tasks
 - Maintenance Rake Tasks
 - Debugging resources for GitLab Support Engineers
 - GitLab Rails Console Cheat Sheet
- GitLab features
 - Install GitLab Runner
 - GitLab CI example projects
 - Elasticsearch
 - Connecting GitLab with a Kubernetes cluster

- Developing GitLab
- GitLab development utilities
- Feature flags
- What requires downtime?

SECTION: support/apac.md

Welcome to Support Team APAC's Handbook page

This page documents items specific to Support Team APAC which we have not yet found a home for in the wider Support Team Handbook.

The intent is to enable APAC Support team members to contribute to Results for APAC-specific initiatives, policies, processes and workflows by prioritizing:

1. Transparency, through being handbook first and providing a single source of truth for APAC-specific.
1. Iteration, through providing a safe space where APAC Support team members can introduce or update APAC-specific policies, workflows and processes without creating confusion and uncertainty for the wider Support Team.

Where appropriate, we should always look to move content from this page into other pages of the wider Support Team Handbook. For an example of how this can be done, see the Considerations in APAC section of the GitLab Support On-Call Guide Handbook page.

General policies

Support Team APAC is One Team

- APAC Support Readiness department members are part of Support Team APAC too.
- Avoid calling individual manager's direct reports group "my team" or "your team".

Support Engineering team members should work primarily during APAC support business hours

- Support Engineering team members are hired in specific locations with an aim to cover specific parts of APAC support business hours.
- When located in a different time zone, team members are granted flexibility to work outside their usual time zone's working hours, but must continue to work within APAC support business hours.
- Exceptions can be made on a case-by-case basis, but must be discussed with and approved by your manager.

Support engineers should be able to work across all GitLab product platforms

- Support engineers should be willing and able to work on problems for all platforms supported by GitLab: SaaS, Dedicated and Self-Managed.

Support engineers should spend time on work other than L&R work

- Support engineers join GitLab with a mix of backgrounds in development, systems administration or support engineering. We want to support people's growth and development by ensuring they maintain and improve the relevant skills they bring with them.
- While L&R problems are often challenging and complex, they are not suited to maintaining those hands-on technical skills. An over-focus on solving L&R problems causes many of these skills to atrophy.
- To avoid this, support engineers in APAC should spend no more than 30% of their time on L&R work.

Working principles

Working principles are behaviors that empower team members to carry out the work of Support Engineering in alignment with the needs of our customers and our business. They help illustrate what applying GitLab's core values and operating principles to Support work looks like.

These working principles are complementary to and should be subordinate to GitLab's core values and operating principles. In case of a conflict between the two, please create an MR to propose a change to or removal of the working principles.

Solve tickets faster

Solving tickets faster can lead to better customer outcomes, and frees up time for Support team members to do what the team needs or what they want, such as new tickets, training or code contributions. These questions might help you apply this operating principle:

- Is what I'm currently doing helping me to solve this ticket faster?
- If we stop or remove a process, will it help us to solve tickets faster?
- Will my ideas and efforts lead us to solve tickets faster as a team?

As we learn more about this operating principle, please leave any thoughts or feedback in the discussion issue.

Make it easy, remove obstacles

We strive to make all of our interactions easy, and to remove obstacles that increase the amount of effort needed to get results. This applies to interactions with our customers, with each other, with the wider team, and anywhere we can live this out. We can ask ourselves: "How can I make this easier? What obstacles can I remove?". Making it easy helps create loyal

customers.

Some examples of how we do that:

- Noticing that a docs page is ambiguous or has poor flow, and raising an MR to make it easier to apply. This makes it easier for customers and team members alike, along with potentially preventing further tickets.
- Helping a customer with a configuration problem and bringing their attention to something else that is likely to come up once they get past their current blocker. If we alert them to it ahead of them encountering it, we remove the need for them to raise another support ticket.
- Giving a customer a clear and succinct summary of what we've understood of their problem and how we're going to proceed to troubleshoot it with them. This makes it easy for them to rapidly identify if we've grasped their situation accurately and can course correct us if we haven't. It also enables the customer to understand where we're going with the actions we're asking them to take, making it easier for them to understand the value of putting in the time they'll need to spend on it.
- Noticing when our own policies are causing us to say "no" and considering if the policy needs to be reviewed. In some cases, that won't be an option -- for example in matters of compliance -- but where it is, taking the time to consider what we can change is worthwhile.

Operating metrics and measurements

Cliff of definite underperformance

A support engineer is definitively underperforming when they handle less than 8 tickets in any of 3 of the past 4 weeks. *<i class="fa-solid fa-triangle-exclamation"></i>*

A support engineer is considered to have handled a ticket when they leave either a public or internal comment on a ticket.

Purpose

To set clear expectations of when a support engineer's ticket productivity is so low that they are no longer performing the basic responsibilities of the role.

{{% alert title="Warning" color="warning" %}}

If you are above the cliff, it does not necessarily mean that you are meeting ticket productivity expectations. The full picture of ticket productivity performance cannot be derived from a single number and must be looked at holistically with other quantitative and qualitative inputs.

{{% /alert %}}

Frequency

Support engineer productivity should be checked against the measurement on a weekly cadence.

The measurement itself should be updated on a quarterly cadence, at the start of

each financial quarter.

<details>

<summary markdown="span">Historical & current data</summary>

The following shows:

- the number for the Cliff of Definite Underperformance (CoDU) as observed for the 12 month period concluding prior to the listed quarter.
- a link to the notification issue when the number was reviewed for that period.

Quarter	Cliff Number	Notification Issue
-----	-----	-----
FY26-Q1 (Current)	8	STM6651
FY25-Q4	9	STM6468
FY25-Q3	9	Not calculated until Q4 so not notified
FY25-Q2	8	STM6046
FY25-Q1	9	STM5821
FY24-Q4	8	STM5672
FY24-Q3	7	STM5494
FY24-Q2	7	Nil - practice started in FY24-Q3
FY24-Q1	6	
FY23-Q4	5	
FY23-Q3	5	
FY23-Q2	5	
FY23-Q1	5	

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown="span">Design considerations</summary>

The following considerations were made while designing this measurement:

- It should include both direct contributions and collaborative work on tickets.
- It should be easy to remember and keep track of.
- It should be naturally achieved in the normal course of work and not require special effort or focus.

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown="span">Getting the measurement</summary>

Use the following instructions to set up a Zendesk Explore report which you can use to get the Cliff of Definite Underperformance number at the start of a new financial quarter.

Building the Zendesk Explore report

Create a Zendesk Explore report using the Support - Updates History dataset.
Use the following settings:

1. Metrics:

- DCOUNT(Tickets updated)
- DCOUNT(Tickets updated w/comment)

1. Rows:

- Updater name
- Updater region (optional, used to verify that data from outside of APAC is not present)
- Update - Year
- Update - Week of Year

1. Filters:

- Ticket form - Excluded:
 - L&R (This is excluded because weekly L&R productivity numbers can get very high.

Setting a standard derived from this number is unfair to support engineers who do not regularly do L&R.)

- Updater tags - Selected:
 - janegianoutsos
 - ketslaats
 - wei-menglee
- Comment type - Selected:
 - Internal
 - Public

1. Visualization type: Table

1. Result manipulation

- Result path calculation - DCOUNT(Tickets updated)
- Pattern: Percentile
- Path: On rows

Getting the measurement from the Zendesk Explore report

In the Zendesk Explore report:

1. Update the date range filter:

1. Click on Update - Week of Year.
1. Click on "Edit date ranges".
1. Under the "Date range" pane, click on the "Simple" tab.
1. Select the "Custom" radio button.
1. Select "month" in the "Details level" select dropdown.
1. Select the previous 12-month period ending at the last FY quarter.
1. Click on "Apply".
1. Sort the Tickets updated column.
1. Look for the first entry above 15%.
1. The cliff number will be the value of Ticket updated w/comment in that row.

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown="span">Monitoring the measurement</summary>

Use the following Zendesk Explore report to provide reporting of how individual support engineers' productivity matches up against the Cliff of Definite Underperformance.

Building the Zendesk Explore report

Create a Zendesk Explore report using the Support - Updates History dataset. Use the following settings:

1. Metrics:
 - DCOUNT(Tickets updated)
1. Columns:
 - Update - Year
 - Update - Week of year
 - Filter > Edit date ranges > Advanced:
 - From the beginning of: 4 weeks in the past.
 - To the end of: 1 weeks in the past.
1. Rows:
 - Updater tags
 - Filter - Selected:
 - janegianoutsos
 - ketslaats
 - wei-menglee
 - Updater name
1. Filters:
 - Comment type - Selected:
 - Internal
 - Public
1. Visualization type: Table
1. Chart configuration > Display format:
 - DCOUNT(Tickets updated) > Advanced:

```
zendesk
IF (DCOUNT(Tickets updated) >= 7) THEN
{
  "backgroundColor": "",
  "precision": 0,
  "scale": 1,
  "prefix": "",
  "decimalSeparator": ".",
  "italic": FALSE,
  "bold": FALSE,
  "suffix": "",
  "fontColor": "",
  "thousandsSeparator": " "
}
ELIF (ISNAN(DCOUNT(Tickets updated))) THEN
{
  "backgroundColor": ""
}
```

```

ELSE
{
    "backgroundColor": "ffcccb"
}
ENDIF

```

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown="span">Documenting the measurement</summary>

When a review of the measurement is carried out:

- Create an MR to:
 - Update the number in the first paragraph of the Cliff of Definite Underperformance section if the number has changed.
 - Add a new row to the top of the Historical & Current Data table for the current quarter's number. Also move the reference to (Current) data to this row.
 - Create a notification issue in Support Team Meta to record that the number has been reviewed and if it has changed. (Copy a previous notification issue to use as a template).
 - Add a link to the notification issue to the relevant column in the Historical and Current data table.

</details>

Holiday Coverage Planning

We are mindful of holidays that impact large parts of the team. The following are official holidays for mostly APAC team members, which we plan coverage for outside of global practices:

Holiday	Date	Countries	Notes
----- ----- ----- -----			

- Australia Day - India Republic Day 26th January Australia, India			
Full region impact as this impacts both our Group 1 and Group 2 on-call coverage.			
Easter Friday	Movable	Australia, NZ, Philippines	
Easter Monday	Movable	Australia, NZ, Philippines	
ANZAC Day	25th April	Australia, NZ	
Let AMER know in time for the Friday prior due to no coverage for first 2-5 hours of business hours on a Monday.			
Monarch's Birthday	1st Monday in June	NZ	
Let AMER know in time for the Friday prior due to no coverage for first 2 hours of business hours on a Monday.			
Monarch's Birthday	2nd Monday in June	Australia (except QLD)	

|
| Independence Day | 12th June | Philippines |
Be aware that this can coincide with Australia's observation of Monarch's Birthday when June 12 is a Monday. |

To refer to past planning issues, see issues linked to the [APAC] Holiday Coverage Planning Issues epic.

Regular Sync Sessions

Weekly	Bi-Weekly/Fortnightly	Monthly/Irregular
- APAC Crush - EMEA/APAC Crush - Support Team Call - L&R Meeting	- Anton Sm's Office Hours - Julian's Kubernetes Help Sessions	- APAC/AMER Crush - Release Review Party - APAC Office Hours - Social Call

- ???

Understanding our working hours in relation to Zendesk

The following images visualise the typical working hours in various team member locations in relation to SLA timers and APAC regional business hours in Zendesk. Pay attention to the months shown in each section - the difference is due to some countries observing daylight savings time.

SECTION: support/channels.md

Our support engineers handle the channels listed below. They are sorted in order of priority (strictest SLA at top), and as a result, it is possible that channels that appear lower in this list experience longer delays in receiving responses. We are actively hiring more Support Engineers to strengthen the team and provide support to the community.

Emergency Tickets

When an emergency ticket comes in, it triggers a PagerDuty incident. All Support Engineers must have the PagerDuty application installed on their phones once they are added to the on-call rotation schedule.

When a PD incident is triggered, the alarm